

You're Wonderful Project; (YWP;)

Pro-Bono Therapy Policy

At You're Wonderful Project, we believe that mental health support should be a right, not a privilege. To bridge the gap in access to quality mental health services, we have instituted a **Pro-Bono Therapy Policy** as a core part of our commitment to social equity and inclusive care.

Commitment to Pro-Bono Work

All mental health professionals working with YWP; are required to offer **pro-bono therapy sessions every week**, as a part of their contribution to building a more accessible and just mental health ecosystem.

Pro Bono Eligibility Criteria

Pro bono sessions are intended for individuals and communities who have historically had limited or no access to quality mental health services. Preference will be given to applicants who fall within one or more of the following groups, particularly in the Indian context.

Eligibility Requirement

Applicants must be Indian nationals.

Priority Groups

- **Economically Disadvantaged Individuals**

Individuals and families living at or below the poverty line, or with unstable and limited income that restricts access to basic needs such as healthcare. This includes daily wage workers, unemployed individuals, domestic workers, and those engaged in informal or unregulated work.

- **Dalit, Bahujan, and Adivasi Communities**

Individuals from Scheduled Castes (SC), Scheduled Tribes (ST), and Other Backward Classes (OBC) backgrounds who experience systemic barriers in accessing mental healthcare. Eligibility is not restricted by income level; however, for OBC applicants, priority is given to those outside the creamy layer.

- **LGBTQIA+ Individuals**

Individuals who face barriers to care due to their sexual orientation or gender identity, particularly those lacking family support or living in unsafe or non-affirming environments.

- **Persons with Disabilities (PWD)**

Individuals with physical, intellectual, or psychosocial disabilities who may face challenges in accessing appropriate and inclusive mental health services.

- **Refugees, Stateless Persons, and Migrant Workers**

Individuals with limited access to institutional support systems, particularly those living in temporary shelters or unstable conditions.

- **Children and Adolescents in Institutional Care**

Young individuals residing in government or NGO-run homes, including child care institutions, open shelters, and juvenile homes.

- **Women and Non-Binary Individuals in Crisis**

Individuals experiencing domestic violence, abuse, or other forms of gender-based discrimination or vulnerability.

- **Individuals Facing Mental Health-Related Stigma**

Individuals who have experienced exclusion, discrimination, or loss of opportunities due to a mental health condition, including those recently discharged from psychiatric institutions.

Referral and Verification Process

YWP; maintains a central list of NGOs, community organizations, and social workers, after which the Peer Support team will connect with them and share about our pro-bono policy, as well as regarding YWP; as an organization. Once YWP; connects with such professionals, they can begin referring individual cases to us for pro-bono sessions. Our PST lead will then assign the case to the appropriate on-board YWP; professional. You can reach out to us via email peersupportteam@gmail.com

As an organization, our outreach exists on platforms like Instagram, LinkedIn as well as an email dedicated to help-seekers to reach out for support. In this case, individual cases reach out to us, and our PST lead will assign the case to the appropriate on-board YWP; professional. Also, in case of such direct contact, our team lead will conduct a verification (such as a brief form or social work assessment) to confirm eligibility.

Therapist Autonomy and Boundaries

Therapists retain the right to decline a case if they feel unqualified or if the referral falls outside their scope of practice. However, they are encouraged to refer such clients back to YWP;'s internal coordination team for alternative arrangements.

Processing Fee

While the therapy session itself is offered free of cost by our professionals, YWP charges a **₹150 processing fee** per pro-bono session. This nominal fee helps cover administrative costs, coordination, and platform maintenance, and ensures that we can continue extending our services to those in need sustainably.

While we are committed to keeping this fee low, this is a minimal cost we will request the help-seeker to bear. In extreme cases of exception, the PST lead will decide what is to be done, based on their discretion.

This policy reflects our collective values and our ongoing effort to make healing accessible, inclusive, and dignified. We thank our therapists for being equal partners in this mission.